PRIVATE COLLECTION | NIGERIA

Johnson **Shobowale**

WORKS FROM A PRIVATE NIGERIAN COLLECTION

36 ARTWORKS | 2013–2024



Collection Catalogue & Provenance Documentation
October 2026

JOHNSON BABATUNDE SHOBOWALE

NIGERIAN CONTEMPORARY ARTIST

Johnson Babatunde Shobowale (born 1970, Nigeria) is a contemporary Nigerian artist whose practice moves between symbolic abstraction, figurative expression and mixed-media experimentation. Across painting, pastel and relief-like constructions, his compositions explore cultural memory, music, spirituality, community and moments drawn from everyday life.

Line is an organising force in Shobowale's art. At times it delineates human figures and expressive gestures; elsewhere it becomes a dense symbolic field. Colour, repeated marks and heavily worked surfaces establish a distinctive dialogue between image and material.

The works in this collection demonstrate Shobowale's experimentation with acrylic, adire and Ankara textiles, sawdust-prepared surfaces, metal foil, board and pastel. His 2014 compositions include heavily textured figurative paintings and metal-foil constructions that approach low-relief sculpture. Works from 2022 and 2023 range from expressive pastel studies of street life to more abstract explorations of movement. In the 2024 paintings, darker surfaces and accumulated layers of pigment and sawdust give familiar subjects an increasingly elusive presence.

The artist's practice is informed by Nigerian cultural experience and a continuing interest in rhythm, pattern and collective identity. The relationship between figure, symbol and texture offers an entry point to the works without restricting them to a single narrative.

SELECTED GROUP EXHIBITION

2001–2024 | REVERSE CHRONOLOGICAL ORDER

2024	SNA October Rain, 18th Annual Juried Art Exhibition, Tim & Carol Gallery of Art, Ikeja GRA, Lagos, Nigeria. 12 November.
2024	SNA October Rain, 18th Annual Juried Art Exhibition, Gemini Art Gallery, King George V Road, Onikan, Lagos, Nigeria. 8 October.
2023	SNA October Rain, 17th Annual Juried Art Exhibition, Tim & Carol Gallery of Art, Ikeja GRA, Lagos, Nigeria. 15–29 October.
2022	SNA October Rain, 16th Annual Juried Art Exhibition, My Drum Gallery, Ikoyi, Lagos, Nigeria. October.
2022	SNA October Rain, 16th Annual Juried Art Exhibition, Adeline Gallery, Ilupeju Industrial Estate, Oshodi, Lagos, Nigeria. October.
2022	Oreze VIII (The King's Crowd), Ime Obi Palace, Awka Road, Inland Town, Onitsha, Anambra State, Nigeria. October.
2018	Iganmode Art Exhibition, Ijamido Town Hall, Ota, Ogun State, Nigeria. December.
2018	In & Out of Africa, Lagos Preview Exhibition, Silverbird Galleria, Victoria Island, Lagos, Nigeria. May–June.
2013	SNA October Rain, 15th Annual Exhibition, Nike Art Gallery, Lekki, Lagos, Nigeria.
2012	Peace Splash: The Artist's Voice for the Peace of Mother Ghana. 17–27 September.
2011	4th Art Expo Nigeria, National Museum, Onikan, Lagos, Nigeria.
2009	2nd Art Expo Nigeria, National Museum, Onikan, Lagos, Nigeria.

SELECTED GROUP EXHIBITION

2001–2024 | REVERSE CHRONOLOGICAL ORDER | CONTINUED

2009	Nigeria–Italy: The Art of Friendship — National Gallery of Art; Sheraton Hotel, Abuja, Nigeria. 1 June.
2008	1st Art Expo Nigeria — National Museum, Onikan, Lagos, Nigeria.
2008	Peace, Peace & Peace — United Nations Information Centre, Ikoyi, Lagos, Nigeria. 23 September.
2006	Drawing Dreams, 8th Lagos Book Festival Exhibition — National Museum, Onikan, Lagos, Nigeria.
2004	6th Lagos Book & Art Festival Exhibition — National Museum, Onikan, Lagos, Nigeria.
2003	Painting Exhibition, 5th Lagos Book & Art Festival — National Museum, Onikan, Lagos, Nigeria.
2002	Art & Book Fair Exhibition — National Museum, Onikan, Lagos, Nigeria.
2001	Drawing Exhibition, 2nd Lagos Book Festival — National Museum, Lagos, Nigeria.

LINE, TEXTURE & THE LIVED WORLD

DEVELOPING VISUAL VOCABULARY

This collection brings together 36 works created between 2013 and 2024. It provides a focused view of Shobowale's recurring interests in human experience, performance and the symbolic possibilities of African visual culture.

THE CONSTRUCTED SURFACE

Sawdust preparation, textile incorporation and metal-foil relief are important material developments. The tactile surface is not merely a support for an image: it participates in the meaning of the work, setting patterns and figures into physical relief.

SOUND, LABOUR AND DAILY LIFE

Figures of drummers, dancers, traders and people navigating rain and city streets recur throughout the group. The subjects anchor the artist's abstract tendencies in recognisable social experience.

THE 2024 WORKS

The latest documented pieces move toward intensely worked, near-black grounds animated by bright traces of paint. Their compression of forms into granular texture offers a notable contrast to the vivid colours and open figure studies of the earlier work.

COLLECTING HISTORY

The collector's relationship with Johnson Babatunde Shobowale began in 2012, marking the start of a longstanding association with the artist and his evolving creative practice. The collector's wider holdings include works produced between 2012 and 2024.This catalogue presents a selection of 36 artworks created between 2013 and 2024, all acquired directly from the artist. Each work is accompanied by an artist-issued Certificate of Authenticity, recording its title, year of production and the artist's signature. The certificates are maintained in a separate accompanying document for verification and provenance purposes.

ABOUT THIS EDITION

INVENTORY

This catalogue documents 36 works by Johnson Babatunde Shobowale, identified sequentially as JBS-001 to JBS-036. Where artworks share the same title, the inventory number distinguishes each individual piece without altering its recorded title.

DIMENSIONS

Dimensions are stated in inches, in height × width (H × W) order. Measurements exclude external framing where confirmed. All measurements are based on the collector's records and should be verified against the physical works before a transaction.

MATERIALS AND TECHNIQUES

Medium descriptions are based on information provided by the collector and the artist's records. They reflect the artist's use of acrylic, pastel, textiles, sawdust-prepared surfaces, metal foil and board. More detailed technical information may be obtained directly from the artist where required.

CERTIFICATES OF AUTHENTICITY

The works are accompanied by artist-issued Certificates of Authenticity, maintained in a separate supporting document. Each certificate is associated with its corresponding artwork through the catalogue's inventory system.

PROVENANCE AND CONDITION

The collector reports acquiring the works directly from the artist. Independent technical examinations, formal condition reports and professional valuations have not been undertaken as part of preparing this publication.

PURPOSE OF THIS CATALOGUE

This publication has been prepared to introduce the collection to galleries, curators and art-market professionals. It brings together artwork illustrations, catalogue descriptions, collecting history and supporting documentation for professional review.

PART I

The 2013 Works

Symbol and Musical Form

JBS-001

The Drummer (2013)

Acrylic on cardboard paper | 24 × 16 inches

An imposing circular drum anchors the composition, while a smaller, mask-like face hovers above it. Shobowale builds the image from sharply contrasting passages of orange, green and dark brown, interrupted by angular markings and fine linear grids. The instrument almost assumes the presence of a second human figure. It is this ambiguity between musician and instrument that gives the painting its character. Sound becomes a visual arrangement of competing shapes, with the drummer seemingly absorbed into the music he produces.



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PART II

The 2014 Works

Symbolic Figuration and Metal-Foil Relief

JBS-002

Olori Oba (2014)

Mixed media: Acrylic on sawdust-primed canvas | 24 × 36 inches

Three elongated female faces stand shoulder to shoulder beneath a shared architectural form. Their near-identical features create an impression of ceremonial unity, yet slight variations in expression preserve their individuality. The dense, incised-looking marks across the reddish surface give the painting an ornamental intensity reminiscent of carved decoration.

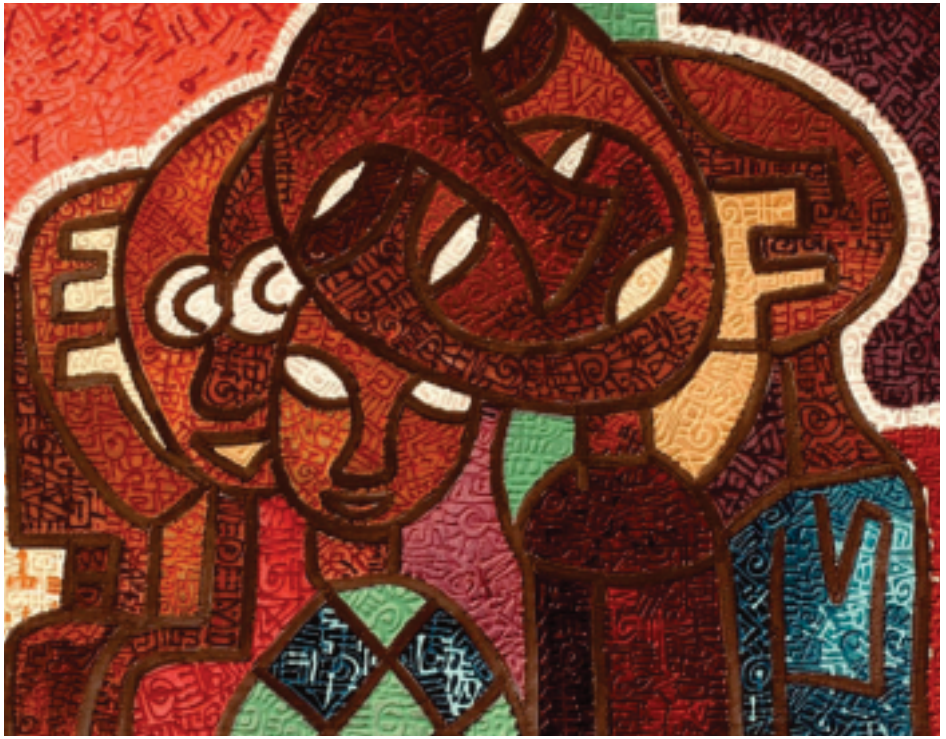
Olori Oba, the Yoruba designation for a king's wife, examines the relationship between royal privilege and female identity. The three figures share the visual language of their status, yet each retains a presence of her own. These women are presented not as passive adornments of kingship but as an imposing collective presence.



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JBS-003

My Joy (2014)



Mixed media: Acrylic on sawdust-primed canvas | 24 × 36 inches

Motherhood takes an unusually abstract form in My Joy. The figures overlap so completely that their heads, shoulders and bodies become difficult to separate. Shobowale draws them together through broad dark contours, setting their earthy reds against smaller passages of turquoise, green and pink. The densely patterned surface reinforces this physical closeness.

Rather than illustrating a conventional mother-and-child portrait, the painting suggests the emotional intimacy of motherhood through forms that seem to grow out of one another.

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JBS-004

Drummer Celebration (2014)



Metal foil on board | 29 × 16 inches

This work has the presence of a carved ceremonial panel. A stylised drummer occupies the narrow central space, surrounded by geometric borders that establish a distinctly architectural frame. Shobowale's treatment of metal foil gives the figure a raised, sculptural quality, while the warm bronze and ochre tones suggest an aged, worked surface. Circular motifs interrupt the angular design, drawing attention to the drum and the musician's body. The result belongs somewhere between painting, low-relief sculpture and ornamental construction.

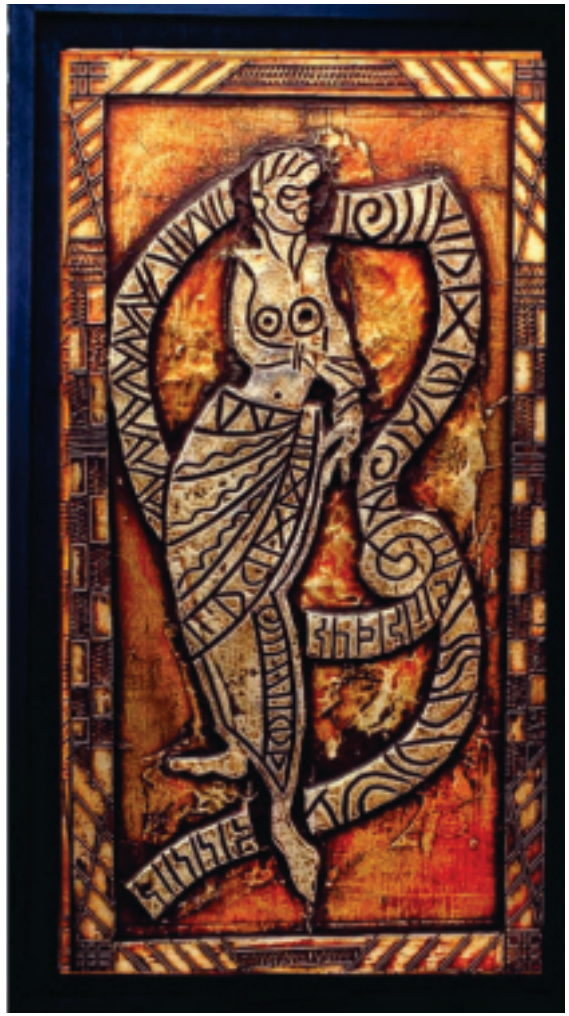
PROVENANCE: Acquired directly from the artist (collector's statement).
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JBS-005

Female Dancer (2014)

Metal foil on board | 29 × 16 inches

The dancer's body bends and extends through a narrow vertical field, her limbs taking on the decorative complexity of the patterns around her. Curving bands and repeated geometric markings suggest motion without relying on naturalistic anatomy. Particularly striking is the way Shobowale transforms the human figure into an almost sculptural arrangement of interlocking surfaces. The metallic finish gives the dancer both delicacy and physical weight. She appears caught between a momentary gesture and a permanent pose.



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JBS-006

Drummer Celebration 2 (2014)

Metal foil on board | 29 × 16 inches

A wide-eyed face dominates this relief, its expressive mouth suspended above a large circular drum motif. The arrangement is deliberately compressed, leaving little distinction between the musician and the instrument. Unlike the more elaborate ceremonial framing of the earlier Drummer Celebration, this piece concentrates attention on facial expression and the bold geometry of the central figure. Rough metallic surfaces, dark recessed areas and simplified features give it a quality reminiscent of constructed sculpture. The exaggerated facial features and compressed arrangement give the figure an engaging immediacy, quite different from the more formal construction of the companion work.



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JBS-007

Untitled (2014)

Metal foil on board | 29 × 16 inches

A woman balances a decorated vessel on her head, her body reduced to an elegant arrangement of narrow limbs, patterned clothing and angular contours. The vessel occupies a surprisingly commanding position, almost larger in visual importance than the figure carrying it. Shobowale uses the raised metallic surface to distinguish the woman from the dark, weathered background. The work finds its strength in this contrast between an ordinary human activity and its almost monumental presentation. A familiar act of carrying becomes an exercise in balance, weight and composure.



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JBS-008

Drummer Celebration (2014)

Metal foil on board | 29 × 16 inches

Here, the musician is defined by a sweeping diagonal body and the emphatic shape of a drum held close to his side. Large curved motifs rise from the lower foreground, creating an impression of movement that extends beyond the figure itself. Shobowale's engraved-looking marks introduce variations in density and direction across the foil surface. Although the composition remains confined within a decorative border, the figure seems to resist that enclosure. The tension between its fixed relief construction and suggested physical movement is particularly effective.



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JBS-009

Happy Home (2014)

Metal foil on board | 29 × 16 inches

Several faces emerge at different heights within a single vertical arrangement. Some appear in profile, others face forward, their outlines joining and separating as the eye travels across the composition. The shared space creates a portrait of family that is less concerned with individual likeness than with relationships.

Shobowale's warm metallic tones and closely worked patterned border reinforce the sense of an enclosed, intimate world. There is no house in Happy Home. Its architecture is made entirely of people.



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PART III

The 2015 Works

Colour, Textile and Social Observation

JBS-010

Festival of Colors (2015)



Mixed media: Acrylic, Ankara fabric on sawdust primed canvas | 24 × 36 inches

A luminous yellow-orange disc breaks through a restless field of intersecting lines, broad colour blocks and irregular painted textures. Unlike Shobowale's figurative works, Festival of Colors offers no central human subject. Its interest lies in the collision of structure and spontaneity. Fine white lines impose a loose grid over passages of red, blue, green and purple, while the unevenly prepared surface interrupts their apparent order. The painting feels almost urban, suggesting the crowded visual experience of a city through abstraction rather than direct representation.

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JBS-011

Untitled (2015)

Mixed media: Acrylic and Ankara fabric on canvas | 24 × 36 inches

Two contrasting faces emerge from a dense arrangement of painted marks, fabric patterns and decorative symbols. One is rendered in deep black with pale, watchful eyes; the other appears in warmer yellow and brown tones. Neither figure occupies a completely independent space. Their surroundings press inward, partly obscuring their identities and complicating the relationship between them. The incorporation of Ankara fabric introduces a distinct visual texture, while the layered composition raises an intriguing question about how much of a person's identity remains visible beneath the patterns surrounding them.



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JBS-012

The Beggar (2015)

Mixed media: Acrylic and Ankara fabric on canvas | 36 × 24 inches

The beggar occupies the lower portion of a crowded composition, almost overwhelmed by the towering architectural shapes and suspended faces above him.

Shobowale uses abrupt diagonals, heavy dark passages and contrasting pinks and greens to create an uneasy sense of scale. The seated figure's extended hand becomes the painting's clearest human gesture. Yet the surrounding figures appear distant, almost inaccessible. Poverty is presented here not simply as an economic condition, but as an imbalance of visibility and power within a shared social space.



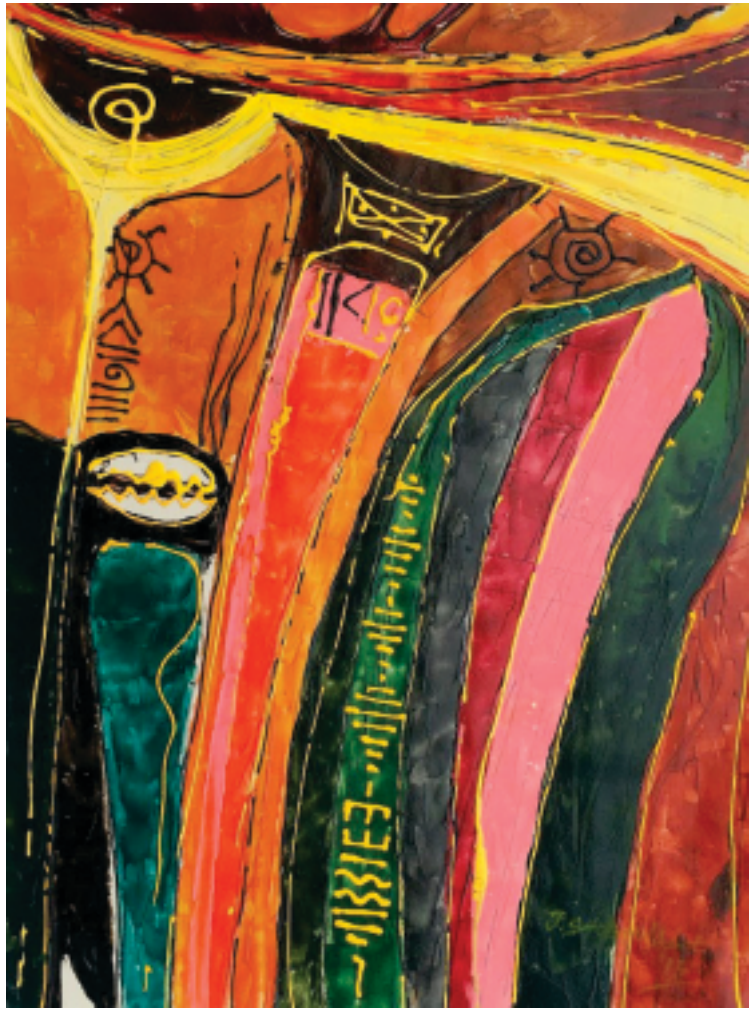
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JBS-013

African Wealth (2015)

Acrylic on Cardboard paper | 23 × 16 inches

Broad vertical bands of green, pink, ochre and dark brown move through the composition like fragments of an unfamiliar landscape. Smaller signs and graphic markings appear within these coloured passages, resisting immediate interpretation. Shobowale deliberately avoids familiar images of minerals, monuments or material riches. Instead, African Wealth presents abundance as a layered visual idea, rich in colour, variation and possibility. The tension between these expansive forms and their narrow boundaries invites a broader reading of Africa's resources and the structures through which they are controlled.



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PART IV

The 2022 Works

Texture, Gesture and the Human Figure

JBS-014

Together as One (2022)

Mixed media: Acrylic on sawdust-primed canvas | 36 × 36 inches

Two human forms are reduced to a continuous, embracing contour. Their heads remain distinct, but their bodies join in a single sweeping shape that almost resembles a vessel. Against the densely marked brown ground, the glowing yellow outlines bring unusual softness to the composition. The sawdust-primed surface gives the surrounding space a tactile complexity, making the simplicity of the figures even more pronounced. Shobowale achieves intimacy through an economy of detail. A slight inclination of one head towards another is enough to suggest affection.



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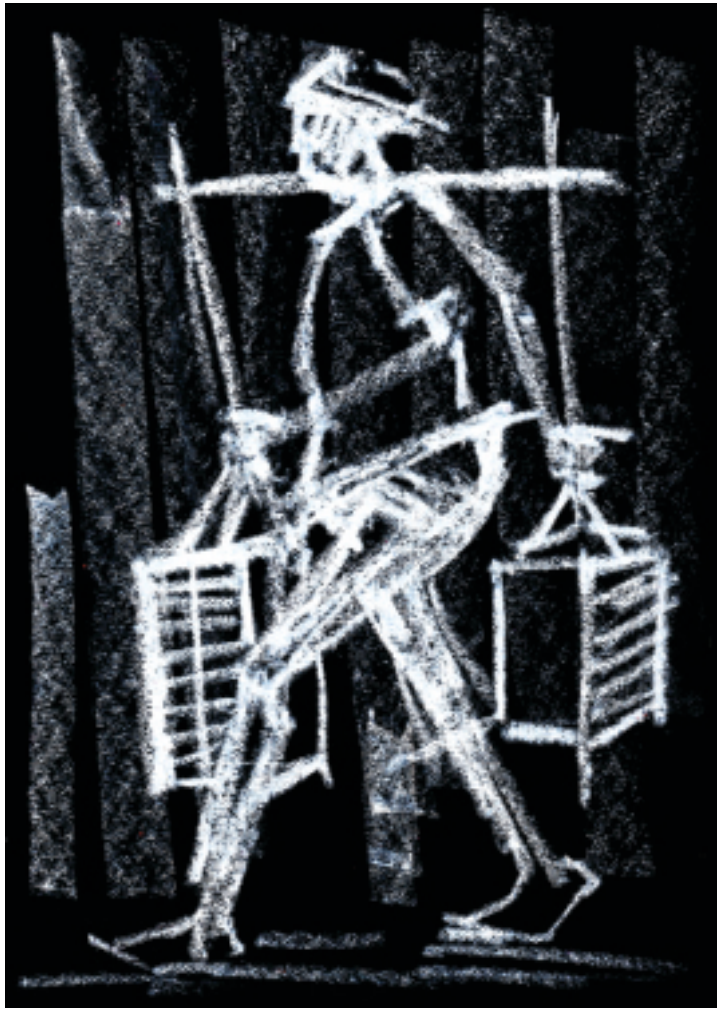
JBS-015

Street Water Carrier (2022)

Pastel on paper | 17 × 12 inches

A water carrier moves beneath the weight of containers suspended from a carrying frame, his body and equipment almost merging into one angular structure. In many Nigerian communities where access to piped water remains unreliable, itinerant water vendors provide an essential service. The trade has long been associated in some urban areas with Hausa-speaking migrants, popularly referred to as aboki.

Shobowale reduces the figure to vigorous white pastel strokes against black, drawing attention to the physical demands of carrying water. The spare composition records an ordinary encounter with a form of labour on which many households continue to depend.



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JBS-016

Drummer Celebration (2022)

Pastel on paper | 17 × 12 inches

With a few rough white marks, Shobowale identifies the sloping shoulders, bent limbs and drums of two performers. The surrounding black is left almost entirely untouched, giving the figures room to emerge through gesture alone. Unlike his elaborate metal-foil interpretations of the same subject, this drawing makes no attempt at decorative detail. Its energy comes from the broken, grainy quality of the pastel and the irregular relationship between the performers. The drawing offers a revealing glimpse of the artist's ability to suggest human activity with minimal means.



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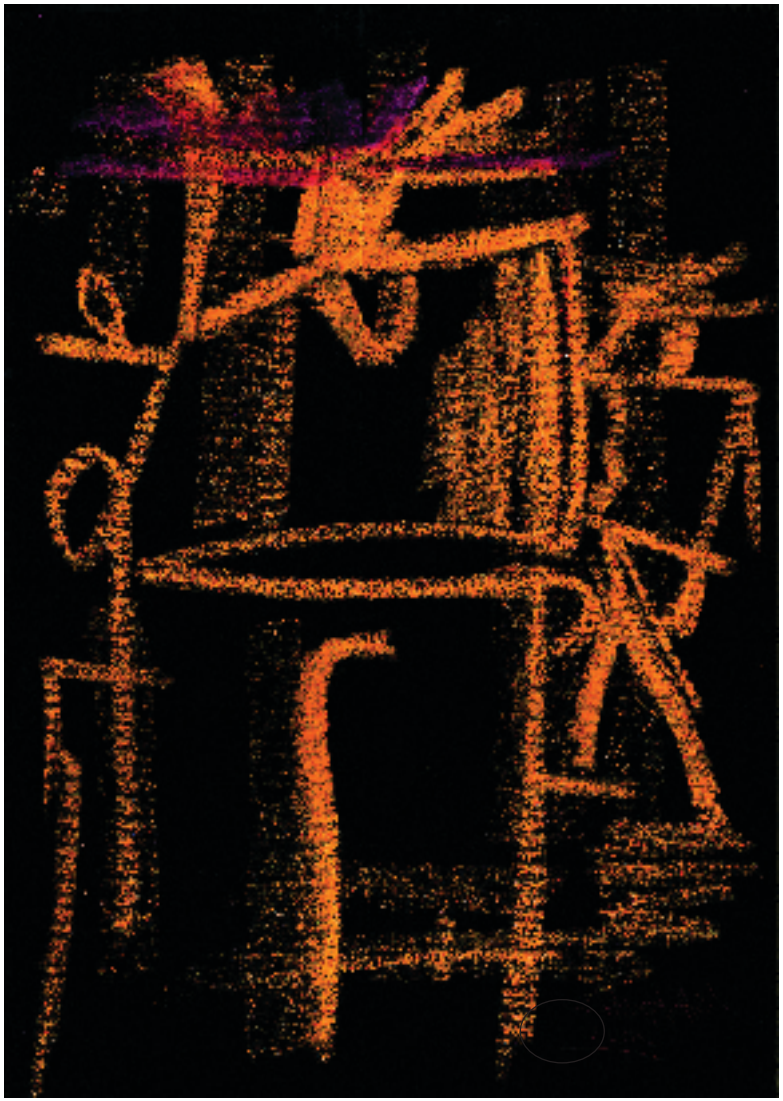
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JBS-017

Street Market (2022)

Pastel on paper | 17 × 12 inches

Bright orange lines cut across a dark surface, suggesting market stalls, upright supports and the crowded geometry of a street trading space. Individual figures are barely distinguishable. Instead, the scene is constructed through fragments, crossings and abruptly terminated strokes. The decision to withhold recognisable detail gives the market an unexpected visual character, as though the artist were recalling its structure rather than recording a particular location. The drawing depends on what it leaves out, allowing a few marks to stand in for the complexity of a busy commercial environment.



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JBS-018

Life Goes On (2022)



Pastel on paper | 12 × 17 inches

There is no obvious beginning or ending to the network of marks in Life Goes On. Black and reddish-brown lines cross, bend and change direction across a largely white surface. Some suggest figures, others appear purely abstract.

Shobowale resists resolving these fragments into a coherent scene, allowing the viewer's eye to travel restlessly between them. The drawing's sparseness is essential to its effect: the empty paper is as active as the marks themselves. Life, the title suggests, seldom provides the comfort of a completed picture.

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JBS-019

Market Woman (2022)



Pastel on paper | 12 × 17 inches

A rush of crimson and pink pastel transforms the market woman into an almost abstract presence. Her form is suggested through a combination of broad rubbed marks, sharper lines and angular interruptions, with generous areas of white paper remaining exposed. There is little of the descriptive detail normally associated with market scenes. Instead, Shobowale appears interested in the physical act of marking and the possibility of capturing a fleeting figure before it disappears into movement. The woman is at once the subject and the organising impulse behind the drawing.

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JBS-020

Rest in Peace (2022)



Pastel on paper | 12 × 17 inches

The title introduces a solemn note to what initially appears to be a lively arrangement of pink marks. Sweeping diagonals, fragmented curves and heavier passages of colour interrupt one another without forming a readily identifiable image.

This tension between the emotional weight of the title and the apparent freedom of the drawing is what makes it interesting. Rather than illustrating mourning through recognisable symbols, Shobowale leaves the experience unresolved. There is movement here, but no destination. That unresolved movement gives the drawing its emotional force.

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PART V

The 2023 Works

Pastel, Performance and Everyday Encounters

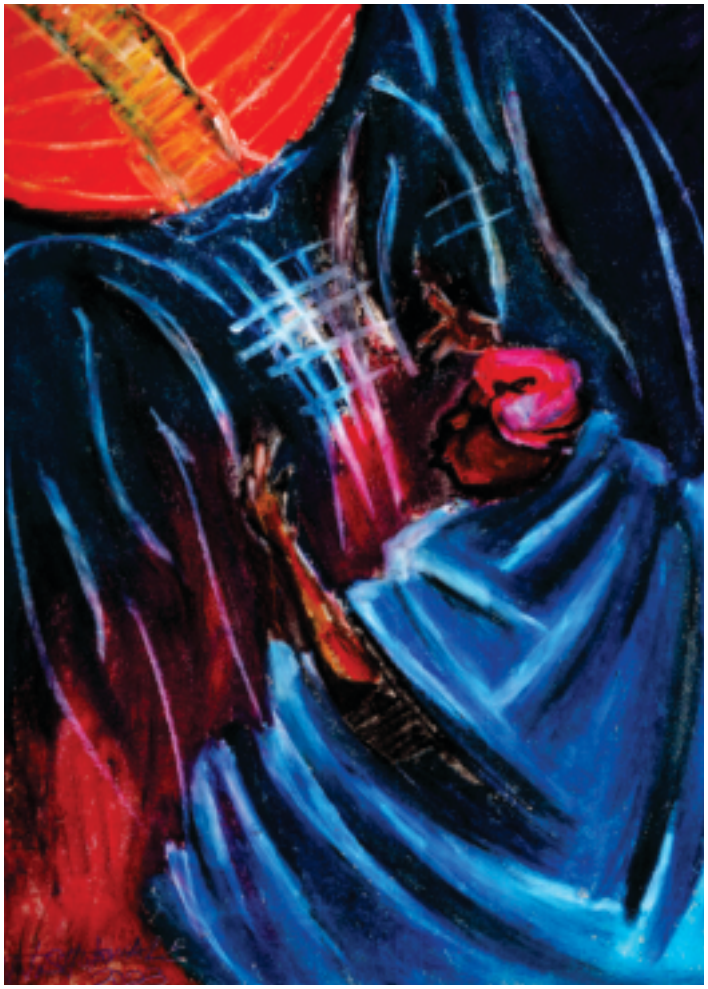
JBS-021

Ṣẹ̀kẹ̀rẹ̀ Rhythm (2023)

Pastel on chipboard paper | 16 × 12 inches

The musician leans into the composition, wrapped in great sweeping passages of blue that nearly absorb the figure. Shobowale offsets these cool tones with a vivid pink face and an orange-red area above, creating a strong sense of visual movement.

The title refers to the ṣẹ̀kẹ̀rẹ̀, a traditional West African percussion instrument fashioned from a dried gourd covered with a network of beads or seeds. Its sound depends on the movement of the player's hands and body, a physical quality echoed in the broad, overlapping strokes of pastel.



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JBS-022

Dances 1 (2023)



Pastel on chipboard paper | 12 × 12 inches

The figure is assembled through vigorous strokes of red, blue, white and green, its body emerging from a field of broken colour. A dramatic red head wrap gives the composition its strongest point of emphasis, while the angled arms and loosely defined torso suggest a movement caught midway through performance. Shobowale allows the pastel to remain visibly rough, preserving the spontaneity of its application. The pastel retains the roughness of its application, giving the dancer an immediacy that a more polished rendering might have lost.

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JBS-023

Rainy Day (2023)

Pastel on chipboard paper | 16 × 12 inches

A barefoot young figure stands beneath an oversized blue umbrella, surrounded by a wash of luminous green. The umbrella's broad canopy dominates the upper composition, creating a sheltered space around the small figure. Shobowale uses dark outlines and loosely blended pastel to distinguish the child's clothing from the wet surroundings. What gives the scene its charm is the child's apparent lack of urgency. The rain is not treated as a dramatic event, but as a familiar interruption in which a young person finds an unexpected moment of freedom.



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JBS-024

Pepper Seller (2023)



Pastel on chipboard paper | 12 × 16 inches

Two broad trays of red peppers occupy the foreground, almost competing with the seated seller for attention. Behind her, a large blue umbrella cuts sharply across a bright yellow-green background. The composition depends on these strong colour divisions, with the vendor's red and white clothing connecting her visually to the produce she sells.

Shobowale gives the peppers generous scale and saturation, allowing the merchandise to become the painting's principal visual attraction. The seller remains composed within this busy arrangement, a steady presence behind the colour and commerce.

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JBS-025

Market Woman (2023)



Pastel on chipboard paper | 12 × 16 inches

Unlike the frontal arrangement of Pepper Seller, this market woman is viewed from the side, her upper body turned towards a series of pepper-filled bowls. Shobowale concentrates on the relationship between her working posture and the merchandise around her. Broad blue strokes describe the folds of her clothing, while the reds and yellows of the produce create a vivid counterpoint. Her face is rendered with relatively little detail, but the inclination of her body conveys engagement in the task at hand. The painting observes the ordinary concentration of work without theatricality.

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JBS-026

Going Home (2023)

Pastel on chipboard paper | 17 × 12 inches

A musician carrying a drum moves through a narrow vertical composition, his body partly obscured by vigorous strokes of blue, red, green and black. The drum's pale circular surface becomes a point of visual stillness amid the restless marks. Shobowale's loose treatment of the legs and surrounding space suggests a journey rather than a fixed pose. The subject offers an interesting reversal of the celebratory musician: performance has given way to departure. The work is concerned with the person who remains when the music is over.



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JBS-027

Dances 2 (2023)



Pastel on chipboard paper | 12× 12 inches

The dancer bends forward so dramatically that the curve of her back becomes the composition's dominant line. A broad red garment spreads across the lower left, while the pale paper around the figure creates a striking sense of openness. Small interruptions of turquoise and pink loosen the silhouette without distracting from its movement. In contrast to the outward energy of Dances 1, this piece feels more concentrated, almost introspective. The emphasis is not on the spectacle of dancing but on the expressive possibilities of a single bodily gesture.

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JBS-028

After the Rain (2023)

Pastel on chipboard paper | 17 × 12 inches

Umbrellas crowd the composition in overlapping circles of orange, red, green, pink and white. The people beneath them are rendered as small, dark shapes, nearly swallowed by the colourful canopies overhead.

Shobowale turns an everyday street scene into a study of repetition and visual density. The umbrellas provide a loose geometric order, while the energetic red and yellow background suggests the movement of people through a shared urban space. There is a playful contradiction in the painting: an ordinary precaution against the weather becomes an exuberant display of colour.



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PART VI

The 2024 Works

Surface, Darkness and Material Experimentation

JBS-029

Fishmonger (2024)

Mixed media: Acrylic, Ankara fabric and sawdust on chipboard | 18 × 12 inches

Four stylised fish are arranged within a dark rectangular enclosure, surrounded by an intensely worked orange surface. Radiating yellow bands draw the eye towards this modest central image, while scattered pale markings interrupt the otherwise dense colour.

The contrast gives the fish an almost ceremonial prominence. Sawdust and fabric contribute to the work's uneven, tactile character, making the background as important as the subject.

Shobowale elevates a familiar item of trade through scale, texture and composition, without losing its connection to everyday economic life.



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JBS-030

Street Hawkers (2024)

Mixed media: Acrylic and sawdust on chipboard | 12 × 18 inches



A group of dark figures moves across a densely patterned orange ground. Their silhouettes are simplified almost to the point of disappearance, blending with the surrounding marks and irregular textures.

Shobowale's treatment of the surface conveys the heat and congestion of urban street trading without describing specific vehicles or locations. The figures seem caught in perpetual motion, with no clear separation between pedestrian and environment. Their near-anonymity draws attention to a familiar contradiction of city life: people whose labour is constantly visible can remain personally unnoticed.

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JBS-031

After the Day's Work (2024)

Mixed media: Acrylic and Ankara fabric on chipboard | 18 × 12 inches

A cluster of angular rooftops rises beneath two striking spiral motifs. Painted drips and intersecting lines run across the picture, partly concealing the architectural forms and giving the work an unusually dense surface. The decorative fabric elements introduce a further layer of pattern, blurring the separation between buildings and ornament.

Although the title suggests the end of human activity, no individual dominates the composition. Instead, Shobowale directs attention to the places people return to when their working day is finished. Home appears here as architecture, colour and the suggestion of lives behind closed doors.



PROVENANCE: Acquired directly from the artist (collector's statement).
CERTIFICATE OF AUTHENTICITY: Artist-issued certificate supplied in a separate accompanying document

JBS-032

Night Hawkers (2024)



Mixed media: Acrylic and sawdust on chipboard | 12 × 12 inches

The painting is almost completely submerged in darkness. Small concentrations of white, orange, red and blue struggle to establish themselves against a heavily textured black surface.

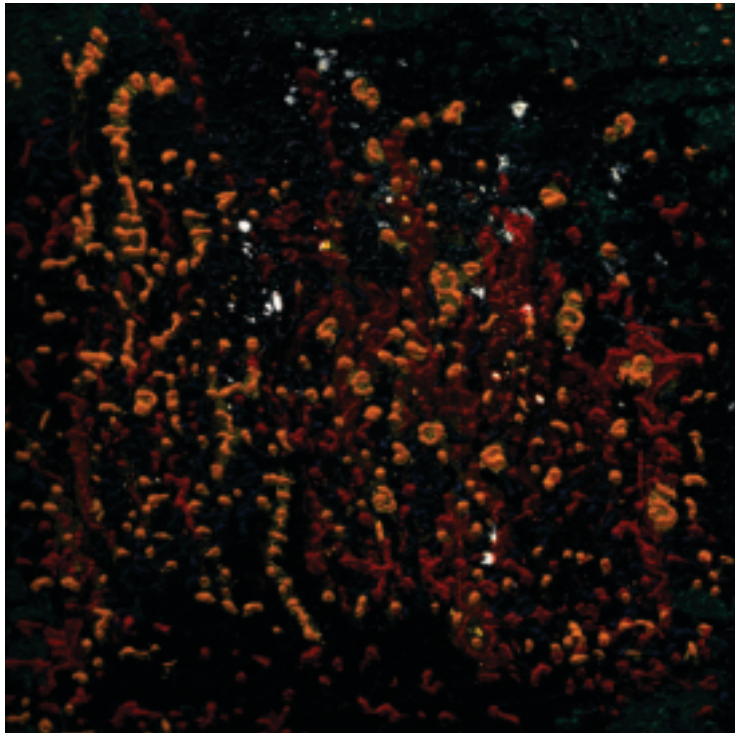
Rather than clearly delineating the hawkers, Shobowale makes the viewer search for their presence among scattered patches of light. The technique reflects the fractured visibility of street trading after dark. The textured ground is particularly effective, absorbing colour in some areas while allowing isolated marks to catch the eye. The subject emerges gradually, much as figures become recognisable in a dimly lit street.

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JBS-033

Untitled (2024)

Mixed media: Acrylic and sawdust on chipboard | 12 × 12 inches



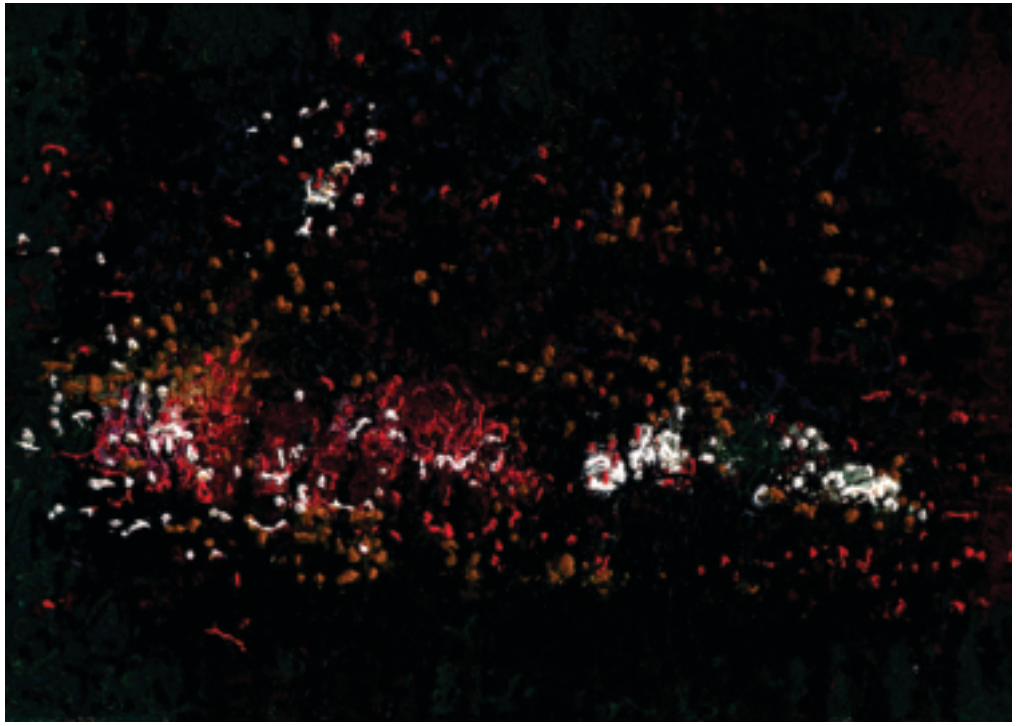
This small work rewards close examination. Across its near-black surface, clusters of orange, red and occasional white marks form an irregular, shifting field. No single figure or object provides an obvious centre, and the viewer is left to discover relationships between colour, texture and density. The accumulated sawdust gives the surface a granular quality that resists the smoothness of conventional painting.

Shobowale allows the material to assert itself independently of representation, creating a composition whose meaning remains deliberately open.

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JBS-034

Night Market (2024)



Mixed media: Acrylic and sawdust on chipboard | 12 × 18 inches

A broken horizontal band of red, white and orange stretches across the dark composition, suggesting the distant concentration of activity in a market after sunset. The surrounding darkness occupies far more space than the illuminated forms, establishing a strong distinction between what can be seen and what remains hidden.

Unlike Night Hawkers, where colour is dispersed across the surface, Shobowale gathers his brightest marks into a relatively narrow area. This horizontal arrangement creates an almost panoramic effect, turning the crowded market into a fragile strip of light against the night.

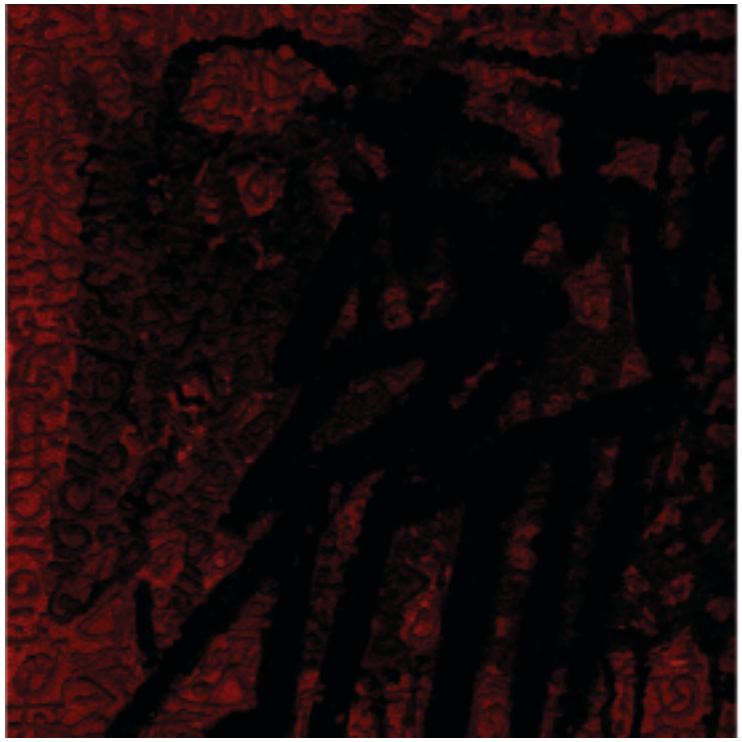
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JBS-035

Life Goes On (2024)

Mixed media: Acrylic and sawdust on chipboard | 12 × 12 inches

Dark forms advance diagonally through a deep crimson field, their contours partly buried beneath the heavily worked surface. The painting is markedly different from Shobowale's open, linear treatment of the same title in 2022. Here, movement seems difficult and weighted, as though the figures must push through the material itself. Red and black remain closely bound, producing a sombre, resistant composition. There is little visual relief, and that is precisely its strength. The work suggests continuation not as an easy promise, but as an effort made despite resistance.



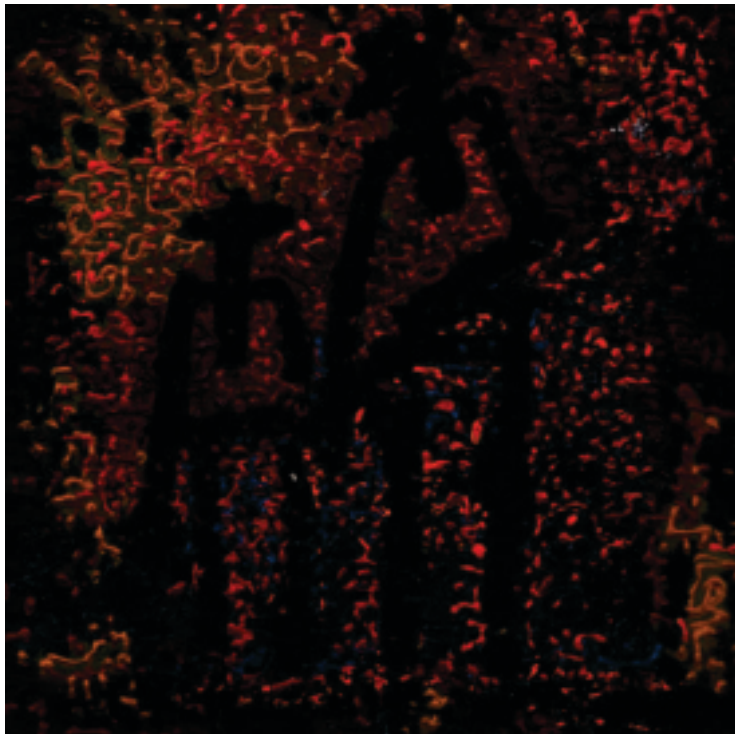
PROVENANCE: Acquired directly from the artist (collector's statement).
CERTIFICATE OF AUTHENTICITY: Artist-issued certificate supplied in a separate accompanying document

JBS-036

Father and Son (2024)

Mixed media: Acrylic and sawdust on chipboard | 12 × 12 inches

Two dark figures appear within a dense field of red, orange and black markings, their forms connected yet not entirely distinct. Shobowale leaves the relationship between them to be discovered through scale, proximity and the direction of their bodies. The raised sawdust texture makes the image difficult to read at first glance, demanding a more patient examination. What emerges is an understated consideration of fatherhood and inheritance. The bond is expressed through the figures' shared physical space rather than sentimental gestures, allowing the painting to retain both warmth and uncertainty.



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